

PAID – Roots and Roofs

Pan-African Indigenous Skills Development Programme

African Inspired Interior & Exterior Architecture · Nigeria Pilot Phase 2025–2026

Role	Programme Communications Coordinator
Organisation	Goethe-Institut Nigeria (Administrative & Financial Lead)
Programme	PAID – Roots and Roofs (Pilot Phase)
Funding	EU Spaces of Culture Programme · EUNIC Cluster Nigeria
Partners	British Council · Irish Embassy · Spanish Embassy · Goethe-Institut
Scope	All 6 geopolitical zones of Nigeria + FCT
Engagement	Jan 2026 – Feb 2026 (contract: Jan 1 – Feb 17, 2026)
Status	Contract role; professional handover completed February 2026

6 Geopolitical Zones	15 Facilitators Managed	24 Programme Participants	7 Stakeholder Organisations
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01 · Programme Overview

PAID – Roots and Roofs was a cultural preservation and skills development initiative funded by the European Union's Spaces of Culture programme and implemented by the EUNIC Cluster Nigeria, a coalition of European cultural institutes and embassies operating in Nigeria. Goethe-Institut Nigeria served as the administrative and financial lead.

The Roots and Roofs pilot theme, *African Inspired Interior and Exterior Architecture*, sought to document, preserve, and revitalise indigenous Nigerian architectural heritage at risk of being lost to rapid urbanisation and generational disconnect. The programme selected young Nigerian creative professionals, working in pairs (an architect/designer and a photographer/visual storyteller), from each of Nigeria's six geopolitical zones and the FCT. Selected teams were trained by expert facilitators in indigenous architectural techniques, then deployed back to their communities to execute small-scale projects and produce documentary outputs.

The selection process ran in two stages: Steering Committee panels evaluated applicants zone by zone to produce a longlist, which a five-member Final Jury then reduced to the confirmed cohort. Training spanned virtual workshops (February 9–10, 2026) and onsite sessions in Lagos (from February 16, 2026).

02 · My Role & Responsibilities

I joined the PAID programme as Programme Communications Coordinator from January 2026, with a formal contract from January 1, 2026. My remit spanned three interconnected workstreams.

Facilitator Coordination & Pipeline Management

The most operationally demanding aspect of my role was building and managing the facilitator delivery pipeline: 15 confirmed facilitators (9 virtual, 6 physical) when regional specialists were included.

- Onboarded confirmed facilitators by specialism and zone, aligning each to specific workshop sessions
- Sent individualised briefing communications confirming session topics, formats, timings, and expectations
- Built and maintained a tracking system for outstanding submissions, invoices, signed contracts, residential addresses, and presentation materials
- Chased outstanding submissions systematically, ensuring all facilitators were fully onboarded ahead of workshop dates
- Coordinated logistics for February 9–10 virtual workshops and February 16 Lagos onsite sessions, both launched on schedule

Participant & Stakeholder Communications

Managing communications across 24 participants, 5 jury members, 12 Steering Committee representatives, and 4 partner organisation leads required clarity, consistency, and appropriate tone across a high volume of concurrent threads.

- Coordinated participant onboarding across all six geopolitical zones: collected bios, profile photos, travel details, and project submission materials
- Liaised with the five-member Final Jury on selection timelines and documentation
- Managed communications with Steering Committee members from Goethe-Institut, British Council, Irish Embassy, Spanish Embassy, IADS, National Troupe, CBAAC, and the EU Delegation
- Maintained programme timeline documentation and flagged and corrected errors in circulated materials
- Drafted and sent formal correspondence on behalf of the programme to all stakeholder groups

Programme Communications & Social Media Strategy

I developed the social media strategy and content calendar for @paid_rootsandroofs across Instagram and Facebook, covering the programme lifecycle from open call through the workshop phase.

- Designed a phased content strategy aligned to the programme timeline, open call, partner spotlights, jury introductions, workshop coverage
- Wrote all captions and carousel copy introducing programme partners, jury members, and the cultural mission of the initiative
- Provided live social media coverage for the February 9–10 virtual workshops and Day 1 of the February 16 onsite Lagos sessions
- Created accessible public-facing content translating the programme's cultural heritage mission to broader audiences

03 · Stakeholder Landscape

The PAID programme operated across an unusually complex stakeholder environment, a multi-partner European consortium embedded within a pan-Nigerian cultural programme. I worked across 7 partner organisations plus jury, steering committee, and participant groups simultaneously.

Implementing Partners (EUNIC Cluster Nigeria)

- Goethe-Institut Nigeria, administrative and financial lead; contract holder
- British Council Nigeria, co-implementing partner; steering committee representation
- Irish Embassy Lagos, co-implementing partner; jury and steering committee representation
- Spanish Embassy Nigeria, co-implementing partner; steering committee representation

Selection Bodies

- Final Jury (5 members): Chadrac Agbodjogbe and Otitoluwa Tubi (independent experts); Aisha Augie/CBAAC, Dr. Mayowa Akin-Otiko/IADS, and Aduke Gomez/Irish Embassy Lagos
- Zone Steering Committees (12 members total, 2 per zone): drawn from all partner organisations plus IADS, National Troupe, CBAAC, and the EU Delegation

Programme Delivery

- ~25 facilitators (15 confirmed, remainder added progressively), coordinated individually for session topics, documentation, and logistics
- 24 participants across 6 geopolitical zones, 12 teams of 2 (architect/designer + photographer/visual storyteller), selected via two-stage process

04 · Key Contributions & Impact

Facilitator Coordination System

The facilitator pipeline was the backbone of programme delivery. With 15 facilitators, each requiring confirmed session details and four categories of documentation, I built a structured tracking system that maintained visibility across all outstanding items. Both the February 9–10 virtual workshops and the February 16 Lagos onsite launch ran on schedule with this infrastructure fully in place.

Multi-Partner Stakeholder Communications

Operating across four European cultural institutions, 12 Steering Committee members, a five-person jury, 24 participants, and 15 facilitators, all with different roles and communication needs, I maintained consistent, professional correspondence throughout my engagement. All programme communications were drafted under Goethe-Institut's institutional authority, requiring particular care with tone and accuracy.

Social Media Infrastructure

I established the @paid_rootsandroofs social media presence from the ground up: developing the content strategy, building the content calendar, writing all copy, and executing live coverage across both workshop phases. This created a public-facing record of the programme's cultural mission extending its reach beyond the immediate participant and partner community.

Professional Handover

When the contract concluded on February 17, 2026, I completed a full structured handover covering social media account access, all facilitator and participant contacts, programme timelines, and outstanding items, ensuring continuity for the programme team. This was completed under significant time pressure, in the middle of live workshops.

05 · Project Management Skills Demonstrated

PM Competency	How It Showed Up
Stakeholder Management	Coordinated across 7 partner organisations, 12 committee members, 5 jury members, ~25 facilitators, and 24 participants, each with distinct needs and authority levels
Project Communications	Drafted all formal programme correspondence; developed and executed social media strategy; live workshop coverage
Delivery Tracking	Built facilitator pipeline tracking system across session confirmations, document submissions, and logistics, enabling both workshop phases to launch on schedule
Risk & Issue Management	Identified and corrected timeline errors in circulated documentation; proactively chased outstanding facilitator submissions ahead of deadlines
Scope Management	Balanced three concurrent workstreams against a compressed programme timeline
Stakeholder Reporting	Maintained documentation standards appropriate to an EU-funded programme under institutional oversight
Project Closure	Delivered comprehensive handover documentation during live workshops under significant time pressure

06 · Tools & Methods

- Stakeholder tracking, spreadsheet-based pipeline management for facilitator documentation and participant onboarding
- Communications management, structured email-based multi-stakeholder correspondence with follow-up cadences
- Content planning, phased social media content calendar mapped to programme milestones
- Social media management, Instagram and Facebook (Meta Business Suite); real-time live event coverage
- Document management, Google Workspace (Docs, Drive, Sheets)
- Project handover, structured closeout documentation covering all workstreams

07 · Reflections & Learnings

The PAID – Roots and Roofs programme gave me hands-on experience coordinating a genuinely complex stakeholder environment, operating across four European cultural institutions, multiple Nigerian government and civil society bodies, and a nationally distributed cohort of creative professionals. The multi-partner structure meant every communication carried institutional weight, requiring careful stakeholder management.

The facilitator coordination workstream was the most operationally demanding I have managed to date. Building a structured pipeline for 15 individuals, each with unique session requirements, documentation obligations, and timelines, while simultaneously managing participant onboarding and live social media reinforced my approach to delivery tracking: visibility, proactive follow-up, and clear ownership of outstanding items.

The contract's early conclusion during live workshops was an uncommon circumstance. My response, completing a full, structured handover document on the same day, reflects my understanding of professional responsibility to a programme and its participants, independent of contractual circumstances.

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